



we installed mate-screensaver back to the system and now it conflicts with mate-screensaver and fails to start. However it must remain so mate notification can work since then all dependencies remain met. How should we ensure



To keep the `mate-screensaver` package installed for dependencies (such as notification services) while ensuring `xscreensaver` runs reliably as the default screensaver daemon, you need to disable `mate-screensaver`'s execution and configure `xscreensaver` to start automatically.

Step 1: Disable the `mate-screensaver` Daemon

Even though the package is installed, you can prevent its background process from running or grabbing DBus interfaces.

1. Disable autostart via desktop settings (Current User):

Run the following `gsettings` commands in a terminal to turn off MATE's idle screen blanking and lock screen daemon:

Bash



```
gsettings set org.mate.screensaver idle-activation-enabled false
gsettings set org.mate.screensaver lock-enabled false
```

2. Disable `mate-screensaver` System-Wide Autostart:

Copy the default autostart desktop entry into your local config (or edit the system-wide file) and set it to `NoDisplay=true` and `AutostartCondition:`

Bash



```
mkdir -p ~/.config/autostart
cp /etc/xdg/autostart/mate-screensaver.desktop ~/.config/autostart/
echo "X-MATE-Autostart-enabled=false" >> ~/.config/autostart/mate-screensaver.de
echo "Hidden=true" >> ~/.config/autostart/mate-screensaver.desktop
```



3. (Optional / System-Wide) Prevent the binary from running entirely:

If MATE desktop components attempt to restart `mate-screensaver`, replace or override the binary:

Bash



```
sudo dpkg-divert --local --rename --add /usr/bin/mate-screensaver
sudo ln -s /bin/true /usr/bin/mate-screensaver
```

How to verify: *Run `pgrep -fa mate-screensaver` . It should return no active processes.*

Step 2: Configure `xscreensaver` to Autostart at Boot

To make sure `xscreensaver` starts every time your session begins, create an XDG autostart file for it.

1. Create a desktop entry in your autostart directory:

Bash



```
cat <<EOF > ~/.config/autostart/xscreensaver.desktop
[Desktop Entry]
Type=Application
Name=XScreenSaver
Comment=Start XScreenSaver daemon
Exec=xscreensaver --no-splash
Hidden=false
NoDisplay=false
X-MATE-Autostart-enabled=true
EOF
```

2. If your distribution uses `systemd` user services (Debian/Ubuntu/Arch derivatives), you can also enable it via `systemctl` so it stays alive:

Bash



```
systemctl --user enable --now xscreensaver
```

How to verify: *Run `xscreensaver-command -ping` in the terminal. It should report that the daemon is running.*

Step 3: (Optional) Map MATE Lock Shortcuts to `xscreensaver`

If you use keyboard shortcuts or menu icons to lock your screen, redirect them to trigger `xscreensaver` :

Bash



```
gsettings set org.mate.Marco.global-keybindings run-command-screensaver '<Control><A'
gsettings set org.mate.Marco.keybinding-commands command-screensaver 'xscreensaver-c
```

